Dundee Sailing and Rowing Club

September 2026 Newsletter

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Commodore's Corner

If anyone was hoping for a quiet August at DSRC…. we clearly didn't get the memo!

It's been a month packed with sailing, rowing, training, jobs around the club and, of course, a little adventure further afield. And when there's an adventure to be had, it doesn't usually take much persuasion for the DSRC members to pack their bags and head off – this time to Portsoy was calling. 😊😊

There have been plenty of laughs, great days on the water, and more than a few stories to tell, so grab a cuppa and read on …

August Adventures – Before We Even Got to Portsoy!

August got off to a flying start! Our Barry Budden outing saw 16 sailors and 6 rowers for a great day out – and thankfully, the only thing being launched at Barry that day were the DSRC boats.

The rowers had a bit of a head start, arriving first and taking the opportunity for a wee wander along the beach till they saw the sailing fleet on the horizon 😊 and once the sailors arrived all 16 of them - it was all hands-on deck to help pull the boats ashore. With everyone safely on the beach and the sun shining, attention quickly turned to the next important event of the day – the picnic! Out came the pieces🍌🥪 and guess what … yes Kerstin was in again! Along with a few other … at this rate we're beginning to wonder whether she joined DSRC for the sailing or simply for access to new swimming spots! 😂🤣

Plenty of Action on the Tay

The rest of August certainly didn't slow down, with some great turnouts for our regular sailing sessions and lots of boats taking to the water.

Thursday evenings have continued to be very well supported as was Saturday or Sunday sailing. It's fantastic to see the enthusiasm showing no signs of letting up.

Then came the **Through the Bridge Sail & Row** on the 18th when both sailors and rowers headed out in some decidedly lively conditions … calm and relaxing it certainly wasn't the wind and the waves adding a little extra excitement – but another great adventure and plenty to talk about afterwards.

Our safety boat crew have certainly been kept busy too. On the 13th, the wind decided to take an early night, leaving a few sailors requiring a little assistance home – Thankfully, our safety boats were on hand to provide a taxi service home . A reminder of just how valuable our safety crew are … Big Thank You to ALL.

Paint, Soup & Plenty of Helpers!

Our Paint & Soup Day on the 12th was another great success, with an amazing **20 willing helpers** turning up armed with brushes, rollers and loads of enthusiasm. First job of the day – choose your colour try not to wear too much of it! There was plenty of laughter along the way, and somehow an impressive amount of painting got done! A few members even brought along some younger family recruits, who rolled up their sleeves and did a fantastic job. And not forgetting Murray who provided the scaffolding and seemed to arrive with every tool you could think of – with plenty of ideas and practical know-how to help keep us on the right footing … **A Huge Thanks to everyone**

The Portsoy Adventure

And then came **Portsoy!**. Some of the advance party arrived on Sunday and, before we'd barely unpacked, we'd been invited along to a barbecue with the Portsoy rowers - which pretty much set the tone for the rest of the week!

What a welcome we received. They showed us their two skiffs and the containers they've transformed into their rowing base and told us how local businesses and the wider Portsoy community had rallied round to help with everything from improving their facilities to providing lifejackets. The community spirit there is quite something.

And then there was **Susan!**. Full of fun, enthusiasm and adventure - and apparently someone who knows absolutely everyone in Portsoy! 😂 Before we knew it, a magnificent haul of freshly caught mackerel had somehow made its way **straight from the fishing boats to the Sail Loft kitchen**. Thankfully, **Wendy's husband Dougie** stepped up to the challenge, cooking the lot and producing a fantastic feast (You really don't get much fresher than that!). 🐟 And that wasn't his only appearance in the kitchen during the week either – by the end of the trip, we're not quite sure if whether Dougie had come for a holiday or had accidentally been appointed **DSRC's resident chef!** 😂👨‍🍳

And not forgetting **Pam and the DSRC neck buffs!** They made the journey northeast too, and before long our rowers were heading out to sea sporting the club colours … **we certainly weren't rowing under the radar**. 🚣‍♀️🤣

As more of our gang arrived on Monday and Tuesday, the Portsoy hospitality just kept coming. Leftovers from Sunday's barbecue? No problem - apparently the answer was simply another barbecue! So off we trotted again on Wednesday for more food, laughter and great company.

Of course, we did manage to fit in some rowing between all this eating! The Portsoy rowers came out with us, shared their local knowledge and showed us the tricks of navigating their two harbour entrances. They couldn't have been more generous with their time - wherever we rowed, they were there making sure we knew where we were going and, more importantly, how to get back again! 😂

By the end of the week, it felt as though we'd known them for years. So on our final evening, it was our turn to return some of that wonderful hospitality, and we invited the Portsoy gang back to the Sail Loft for a wee DSRC shindig - plenty of food, refreshments, laughter and stories to round off a fantastic adventure.

The best bit? **They're coming to visit us next year!** Some are already keen to swap their oars for sails and have a go at sailing as well as rowing when they come to Dundee. After the welcome they gave us, we've certainly got a hard act to follow - but we're already looking forward to returning the hospitality and showing them how we do things on the Tay! ⛵🚣‍♀️😂

Work First … Party Later 🧹🎉

Before the bonfire celebrations could begin, there was still work to be done! **A BIG thank you** to everyone who came along to help at our monthly Work party earlier in the day and got stuck in. Jobs done, tools away – now it's time to swap work party for party! 🤣

Bonfire, Band & a Brilliant Night! 🔥🎶

What a way to round off August! We had a fantastic turnout for our **Bonfire & Band Night**, with a roaring bonfire outside, live music, food and cakes, and everyone arriving with their refreshments ready for a great night.

And yes … **Murray and his scaffolding made another appearance!** 😂 This time it wasn't for painting, but to get everything set up outside, complete with a camera capturing the evening. Between Murray's camera and everyone's phones, we reckon there may now be more photographs of the night than there were people there!

A HUGE thank you to **Kerstin and the team** for all the work that went into preparing everything, to everyone who brought along food and baking, and to those hardy souls who stayed behind to help with the clear-up afterwards.

And it seems the fun didn't stop when the bonfire went out! **Mandy's posts from the night** clocked up an amazing **900 views in just an hour and a half** – clearly everyone wanted a peek at what DSRC have been up to.🔥

Great music, great food, a blazing bonfire and even better company - **a cracking night and a brilliant way to see August out in true DSRC style!** 🔥🎶🥳

⛵ Looking for a New Home …

We have a Wanderer sailing dinghy for sale, available to members for £500 … O.N.O. If you're interested, please get in touch and let us know. We also have a fiberglass tender available. No oars included, but plenty of potential! **We're open to reasonable offers**, so if you are interested please get in touch.

Dates to Remember

- Harvest Home – Friday 9th October 7pm–11pm, tickets £12.50 each now available
- Forfar Regatta – Saturday 17th October
- Club AGM - Sunday 22nd November, 2pm
- Christmas Party – Friday 4th December

Until Next time

As we sail out of August, let’s keep the wind in our sails, the oars pulling together and the laughter flowing Fair winds and happy rowing everyone!

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